

MALACHI I. II.

burnt and there is offered unto my name, even a pure offering; for great is my name among the nations, saith the LORD of hosts.

12 But ye profane it, in that ye say, The table of the LORD is polluted, and by the assertion,^a Its food is contemptible.

13 And ye have said, Behold, what a wearisome task is it! and ye have left it to famish,^b saith the LORD of hosts; and ye have brought what was robbed, and the lame, and the sick, and thus ye have brought an offering: should I accept this in favour from your hand? saith the LORD.

14 But cursed be the deceiver, who hath in his flock a male, and voweth, and sacrificeth a corrupt^c thing unto the Lord; for I am a great king, saith the LORD of hosts, and my name is feared among the nations.

CHAPTER II.

1 And now, this commandment is for you, O ye priests.

2 If ye will not hear, and if ye will not lay it to heart, to give glory unto my name, saith the LORD of hosts: I will even send out against you a curse, and I will curse your blessings; yea, I will curse the same,^d because ye do not lay it to heart.

3 Behold, I will destroy unto you the seed, and spread dung upon your faces, even the dung of your festive offerings; and one shall take^e you away with it.

4 And ye shall thereby know that I have sent out unto you this commandment, that my covenant might be with Levi, saith the LORD of hosts.

5 My covenant was with him life and peace; and I gave them to him for the fear^f wherewith he feared me, and because of my name he had dread.^g

6 The law of truth was in his mouth, and

falsehood was not found on his lips: in peace and equity he walked with me, and many did he turn away from iniquity.

7 For the priest's lips are ever to keep knowledge, and the law are they to seek from his mouth; for he is the messenger of the LORD of hosts.

8 But ye are indeed departed out of the way; ye have caused many to stumble in the law; ye have corrupted the covenant of the Levite, saith the LORD of hosts.

9 Therefore have I also made you contemptible and low before all the people, in the same measure as ye do not keep my ways, but act with partiality^h in the law.

10 Have we not all one father? hath not one God created us? (then) why shall we deal treacherously every man against his brother, to profane the covenant of our fathers?

11 Judah hath dealt treacherously, and an abomination hath been committed in Israel and in Jerusalem; for Judah hath profaned the sanctuary of the LORD which he loveth, and hath married the daughter of a strange god.

12 The LORD will cut off unto the man that doth this, son and grandson,ⁱ out of the tents of Jacob, and him that bringeth near an offering unto the LORD of hosts.

13 And this do ye secondly, covering the altar of the LORD with tears, with weeping and with loud complaint, so that he turneth not any more his regard to the offerings, nor receiveth it with favour at your hand.

14 Yet ye say, Wherefore? Because the LORD hath been witness between thee and the wife of thy youth, against whom thou hast indeed dealt treacherously: yet is she thy companion, and the wife of thy covenant.

15 And not one doth so who hath^k a rem-

^a Redak, giving it with, "the assertion of the priest." Others, "its income, its food (*i. e.* of the table of God, the altar,) is contemptible."

^b Arnheim and Rashi. Others, "let it grieve." Philippon, simply, "despised it."

^c *i. e.* An animal with a bodily defect.

^d Arnheim ingeniously refers אֲרִימְתִּי to the elliptical אֶרֶץ "the earth,"—"the very earth will I curse."

^e This difficult phrase is given by Rashi, "this dung will carry you up to itself," *i. e.* make you as contemptible as it is. Aben Ezra, "the enemy carrieth you along with him." Philippon, "and this is to honour you."

^f Rashi, "that he should fear, and so he did fear me."

^g Johnson, "he bent himself before my name."

^h *i. e.* Favour the great so as not to reprove them. Philippon deems the negative of the first part of the sentence to be omitted before the last, and renders, hence, "and honour not the law."

ⁱ Jonathan. The Talmudists, "teacher and scholar."

^k Verses 15 and 16 are rendered after Zunz and Philippon, who chiefly have followed Aben Ezra; but Jonathan, "Behold, Abraham (אֲבִרָם) the eminent *one*, or the first father of our people,) was an only one, from whom the world (Israel) was created; and what did this one require? nothing but that a child be preserved to him from before the LORD; therefore, &c. For if he hate her, let him dismiss her,—and not cover over violence with a garment," &c. The last clause is explained, "treating a wife